

Erik Taylor

Senior Product Designer

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Senior Product Designer with 10+ years on complex enterprise B2B products and a shipped record of AI-empowered workflow design. Built AI tooling where the core design decision was trust and oversight: what automation handles invisibly, and what stays observable and verifiable so users remain in control. Turns in-depth user research into design decisions and product direction, leads ambiguous projects from concept to delivery, and mentors designers on accessibility and visual systems. Expert in Figma, experienced building and maintaining design systems, with strong typography and visual craft. Practical judgment about when AI accelerates design work and when deeper human evaluation is required, built from daily practice rather than experimentation.

CORE SKILLS

AI-Empowered Design: AI Workflow Design with Human Oversight, Trust and Transparency Patterns, Custom Claude Skill Development, Claude Code, AI-Assisted Ideation, Synthesis, and Prototyping, Judgment on AI Acceleration vs. Human Validation

Research: In-Depth User Research, Usability Testing, Customer Journey Mapping, Service Blueprinting, Research Communication Across Teams, Evidence-Based Validation

Product Design: Complex Workflow Framing, End-to-End Design from Concept to Delivery, Wireframes to High-Fidelity Mockups, Interactive Prototyping, Information Architecture, Edge Case Design

Visual Design: Typography, Color, Layout Systems, Interaction Design, High Craft Bar Across Product Areas

Systems & Leadership: Design Systems and Libraries, Component Patterns and Consistency, WCAG 2.1 AA Accessibility, Design Mentorship, Stakeholder Communication of Rationale and Tradeoffs, Agile Delivery

Tools: Figma, Figma Make, Claude, Claude Code, ChatGPT, Sketch, GitHub, Jira, Miro, Notion

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Freelance (Remote)

June 2026 - Present

Product Designer

- Independent product design practice on enterprise B2B and AI-empowered workflows, and practical tools and frameworks for designers working with AI, published at erikftaylor.gumroad.com.

Tovuti LMS (Remote)

July 2025 - June 2026

Product Designer

- Built JEM, an AI journey-mapping tool developed partly in Claude Code that cross-references support and CRM data to flag friction step by step; designed it so AI findings stay fully observable and verifiable by the team rather than auto-applied, keeping humans in control of decisions; surfaced 20 fixes, 10 shipped within a week.
- Designed and shipped 10 custom Claude skills automating research synthesis, drawing the automation line deliberately: mechanical aggregation ran invisibly while decision-driving output remained human-reviewed; saved an estimated 10-15 hours per cycle.
- Owned end-to-end design for an enterprise learning platform from ambiguous concepts through delivery, turning multi-source research into product and backlog decisions with product and engineering.
- Built the design system and component library that 8-12 engineers shipped from, with WCAG 2.1 AA built into every component from the start.

Transamerica (Financial Services)

November 2020 - November 2024

Senior UX Designer

- Led the high-fidelity redesign and information architecture overhaul of a complex advisory platform in a regulated environment, grounded in research with 100+ financial advisors; leadership tied the work to a 30% increase in adoption among new agents.
- Communicated research learnings and design tradeoffs across compliance, product, and engineering through workshops that shifted product direction and surfaced service gaps leadership had not seen.
- Mentored designers on accessibility and visual systems and set the UI/UX standards the team designed against, raising design quality across projects.

IBM (via APC)

July 2017 - July 2020

Product Owner / UX Designer

- Owned product strategy and end-to-end design for a global enterprise platform, framing ambiguous problems into backlog priorities for agile teams; contributed to 20% adoption growth.

IBM (via APC)

January 2010 - July 2017

Team Lead / Copywriter

- Led global content operations producing 2,500+ client profiles a year and redesigned the editorial workflow to make it 50% more efficient.

EDUCATION

University of Denver

UX Design Bootcamp Certificate (2020)

Human-Centered Design methodology, qualitative research methods, journey mapping, usability testing

University of Massachusetts Amherst

B.A., English Language & Literature